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OnePlus 2

The Second Coming

If you were worried about the Snapdragon 810's heating issues, then let us confirm here that OnePlus has dealt with them effectively. The OnePlus 2 goes for a lower clock speed (of 1.7GHz), which means about 30% lesser performance than the max clock. In addition, there's a cooling paste that has been added to allow for 5-10% lower temperatures. As a result, the OnePlus 2 doesn't heat up abnormally. After extended periods of gaming, if you keep the phone down, the paste cools it down really fast too. The lower clock though results in lower benchmarks, which is fine, since the OnePlus 2 handles every task that you can throw at it like a boss.

OnePlus also ticks a spec-sheet checkmark with the laser-assisted auto-focus camera. The 13MP camera on the back though doesn't focus as fast as the laser system on the LG G4. That said, the OnePlus 2 still takes really good pictures, which are better than the OnePlus One. The camera is much improved and does its best in macro shots. This of course is where the laser auto-focus comes in most handy. Images taken by the OnePlus 2 are accurate in terms of colour reproduction and white balance.

Perhaps the only real weakness that the OnePlus 2 had are in its display and UI. The 5.5 inch FHD display is fine on paper, but it's very easy to discern that OnePlus has cut costs here. The display has a low refresh rate, which shows easily sometimes. It is also quite dim and dull.

This is complemented by OxygenOS, which is still quite buggy. The phone froze due to UI glitches on multiple occasions, while we also found our cellular data turned off for no reason on multiple occasions. In addition, some apps never got up and running on the OnePlus 2. On the one hand, the glitchy UI could be a problem, but on the other, it is also a statement. It shows that OxygenOS is still a work in progress and additions will be made



Price
₹24,999 (64GB)
₹22,999 (16GB)

with each new device. We really liked the Shelf screen and the hardware button for changing ringer modes. The fingerprint sensor is not as fast as Apple's, but it does the job.

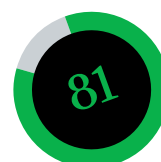
Another area where the OnePlus 2 is somewhat weak is its battery life. The 3,300 mAh battery can't last you a full day, but does the job in terms of practicality. On a very busy day where the phone was used intensively, we could get it to last for about 10 hours without using the battery saver modes, and with the screen turned up on full brightness. On our battery test, the phone lasted for about seven hours, which is just about fine. So, as mentioned above, the battery is fine for practical purposes, but we

wish it was better.

Lastly, the build quality of the OnePlus 2 is quite good, and we daresay different from the OnePlus One. While the Sandstone back is the same as the original, it's on a thin plastic plate this time, which makes it feel rather low grade as compared to the last one. It is also easier to scratch. OnePlus has also added a metal frame, which really serves no purpose except fill another checkbox on the spec sheet. In fact, with the companies Styleswap wood covers, the metal frame feels out of place.

Overall, the OnePlus 2 comes out as quite the performer, but not what the OnePlus One was. It's not the out and out flagship killer that OnePlus launched last year, but a very balanced smartphone that provides very good value for money. If you're buying a new smartphone, then the OnePlus 2 would be a good phone to go for. On the other hand, if you currently have a OnePlus One, then don't ditch that for this one. The OnePlus 2 is an incremental update on the OnePlus One, and not one that qualifies as an 'upgrade'.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.5-inch FHD;
Battery: 3,300 mAh;
Processor: 1.7 GHz
Qualcomm Snapdragon 810 octa-core 64-bit SoC;
Camera: 13 MP rear, 5 MP front; **OS:** OxygenOS 2.0 over Android 5.1.1; **Storage:** 64 GB; **RAM:** 4 GB

Contact

OnePlus
Email: support.in@oneplus.net
Phone: 0008008522008
Website: oneplus.net/in